

Inexperience stings Elyria

Pioneers drop LEL opener to senior-laden Cleveland Hts.

Tim Gebhardt
The Chronicle-Telegram

ELYRIA — Not quite ready for prime time.

Elyria's young basketball team found out quickly just how much damage a big, strong, quick team could do Tuesday night as it fell to a seasoned Cleveland Heights wrecking crew on the Pioneers' home floor.

The senior-dominated Tigers rolled to a 29-11 first quarter lead and went on to defeat Elyria, 90-63, in the teams' Lake Erie League opener. Both are 1-1 overall.

Heights dropped its opener to St. Ignatius while the Pioneers upended Avon Lake.

Wide-bodied 6-foot-8 Rasheed Bonner of Heights pretty much had his way under his own basket, hitting 11 of 12 close-range shots to lead Heights' scoring with 22 points. Elyria simply had no one big enough to contest Bonner.

"There's not much we can do about size and quickness," said Elyria coach John Srim. "We needed to slow the game down, but their helter-skelter defense — racing up and down — gave our kids some open shots. Unless it's a layup, we have to pull it out and run our offense. We took three bad shots and they took off on us."

While Bonner provided the size, the quickness came in droves.

Michael Dues, Brandon Dominick, William Witcher and what seemed to be a cast of thousands took turns pes-

ELYRIA									
Player	GA	F	FT	P	GA	F	FT	P	
Richard Montague	19	12	3	25	10	6	3	13	13
Eric Sims	8	5	3	13	10	6	3	13	13
James Hall	10	5	2	12	10	6	3	13	13
Ken Gettis	3	3	3	6	3	3	3	6	6
Brett Godbolt	3	3	3	6	3	3	3	6	6
Doug Medvetz	3	3	3	6	3	3	3	6	6
Paul Tette	3	3	3	6	3	3	3	6	6
Dwayne Ham	3	3	3	6	3	3	3	6	6
Melvin Pickens	3	3	3	6	3	3	3	6	6
TOTALS	58	28	19	63	58	28	19	63	63

CLEVELAND HEIGHTS									
Player	GA	F	FT	P	GA	F	FT	P	
Rasheed Bonner	12	11	1	22	10	9	0	15	15
Brandon Dominick	10	6	0	12	10	6	0	12	12
Michael Dues	7	7	5	14	7	7	5	14	14
William Witcher	7	7	5	14	7	7	5	14	14
Vince Cistrunk	11	4	0	9	11	4	0	9	9
Terrence Holloway	4	2	0	4	4	2	0	4	4
Sam Gorman	2	2	0	2	2	2	0	2	2
Tim Crawford	3	3	1	4	3	3	1	4	4
Ronald Donaldson	3	3	1	4	3	3	1	4	4
Mark Chapman	2	2	0	2	2	2	0	2	2
Dan Johnson	1	1	0	1	1	1	0	1	1
Roger McClinton	1	1	0	1	1	1	0	1	1
Darnell Ford	1	1	0	1	1	1	0	1	1
Michael Mahoney	1	1	0	1	1	1	0	1	1
TOTALS	73	39	14	80	73	39	14	80	80

Three-point field goals: Elyria: Sims, Bonner, Dominick, Dues, Cistrunk, Crawford. Rebounds: Elyria-34, Cleveland Heights-30. Turnovers: Elyria-21, Cleveland Heights-12.

SCORE BY QUARTERS											
	1	2	3	4	T		1	2	3	4	T
Elyria	11	21	13	18	63						
C. Heights	28	24	19	18	90						

Junior Varsity: Cleveland Heights, 59-55.

tering Elyria's offensive effort, forcing 21 Pioneer turnovers.

"We hit some threes and everything fell into place. We saw them (Elyria) play Avon Lake. We thought they could be pressured and they didn't offer any pressure in return. They pretty much rely on (Richard) Montague and (Ken) Gettis."

Montague did his best to keep Elyria in the game with 25 points. Gettis, still somewhat rusty after the football season, added five points and helped Elyria to a slight rebound edge thanks, in part, to Heights' red-hot shooting (53 percent).

The sophomores — Eric Sims and Darnell Hall — con-



STEVE MANHEIM / CHRONICLE

GETTING HIS DUES: Elyria's Richard Montague gets off a shot over the attempted block of Cleveland Heights' Michael Dues Tuesday night at Elyria High. Montague led the Pioneers with 25 points.

tinued to impress with strong outings. Sims had 13 points, Hall 10 and both showed flashes of great things to come. Elyria has only two seniors on its roster.

In the junior varsity contest, Elyria (1-1) saw a four-point halftime lead evaporate quickly in the third quarter and lost to Heights, 59-55.

Antonio Ward (13 points) and Melvin Pickens (12) paced the Pioneers. Aaron Nixon took scoring honors with 21 for the Tigers.

Elyria is at Medina in non-conference play Saturday night while Heights faces highly regarded Shaker at Cleveland State Saturday afternoon.

Boys Basketball Rangers rally, but fall short

James Waltz
The Chronicle-Telegram

ROCKY RIVER — There are many types of wins. Good wins, bad wins, blowout wins and ugly wins.

In the eyes of Rocky River head coach Jim Rucki, the Pirates' 69-58 non-conference victory over North Ridgeville on Tuesday fell into the ugly category.

"It's nice to win, but we're not playing like a team," said Rucki, whose Pirates were outscored 18-14 in the fourth quarter. "We're not rebounding on either end; we're not playing basic, fundamental basketball, and our team is not in sync."

OUCH, who won again? "We've got some guys who have offensive skill and we're depending on them heavily."

Make that four guys with lots of shooting ability.

Of the six Pirates who put points on the board, four scored 12 or more points led by senior John Caruso with 19.

Caruso scored 12 of those in the first quarter, including a pair of 3-pointers, to help the Pirates build a nine-point lead at the end of one, 25-16.

When Caruso cooled off in the second quarter, teammate Mike Woodward picked things up, chipping in six of his 17 points to push the lead at the half to 42-29.

The Pirates built as much as a 19-point lead late in the fourth

before the Rangers cut it to 11 before the final buzzer.

Despite River's dominance, Rucki was still critical.

"We gave then too many second chances. If we don't block out, that's going to hurt us," he said. "We did have good guard play."

Rounding out River's high-scoring quartet were 6-4 senior Dave Miller (14 points) and guard Jeff Peate (12).

North Ridgeville coach Dan Rademaker had some compliments for the Pirates. "Rocky River is a pretty good team. They have a lot of weapons."

North Ridgeville's weapon was Matt Davin. The senior guard scored all of his team-high 15 points in the second half to keep the Rangers in the game.

"We are going to need Matt to keep scoring for us," said Rademaker. "We lost our composure. If we had hit a couple close shots and gotten to the foul line more, I think we would've been in this game."

NR									
Player	G	F	T	RR	G	F	T		
Workman	1	0	3	Peate	5	2	12		
Nelson	1	0	3	Caruso	8	1	19		
Davin	7	0	15	Andrew	2	1	5		
Mock	7	0	14	Rickard	0	0	2		
Barrett	2	0	5	Woodward	6	4	17		
Witter	0	0	0	Miller	6	4	12		
Thompson	4	0	9						
Lime	1	2	4						
Dye	1	2	5						

Totals 25 4 58 Totals 28 14 69
Points by Quarters 1 2 3 4 T
NR 16 12 11 18 — 58
RR 25 17 13 14 — 69

Three-point goals: RR — Caruso 2, Woodward; NR — Workman, Nelson, Davin, Thompson.

JV: NR 70-40.

BULLETIN BOARD

YOUTH BASEBALL/SOFTBALL

LCCC NEEDS COACH: Lorain County Community College needs a volunteer fastpitch softball coach for the 1999 season. The college is sponsoring a team which will compete as a club sport. If interested, call Dick Roth at the LCCC HPER department, 385-5222, ext. 7349.

PREP BASKETBALL ROUNUP

Highland trio stumps Brookside

SHEFFIELD — Nate Blower, Adam Kruse and Jacob Brown combined for 39 points to lead Highland to a 71-55 non-conference win over Brookside.

Kurt Scarvelli topped the Cardinals with 12 points. He was joined in double figures by Jeremy Dennis (10).

The Cardinals, 1-1, travel to North Ridgeville on Friday.

Highland									
Player	G	F	T	Brookside	G	F	T		
Kruse	5	0	13	Leonard	5	3	0	16	
Schroeder	5	2	8	Scarvelli	5	2	12		
Wagner	0	1	1	Cassey	0	2	2		
Wasko	1	0	3	Browning	4	1	9		
Annibale	2	1	5	Wright	2	0	5		
Brown	5	12	12	Miller	1	1	3		
Boydman	4	0	8	Dennis	1	5	10		
Blower	6	2	14	Blasig	3	2	8		
Davis	3	1	7						
Lawrence	3	1	7						
Totals	30	7	71	Totals	23	8	55		

Points by Quarters 1 2 3 4 T
Highland 10 25 17 19 — 71
Brookside 16 10 12 17 — 55

Three-point goals: Highland — Kruse, Wasko, Brown; Brookside — Washington.

Junior Varsity: Highland won.

Heritage Christian.....65
Lake Ridge.....43

NORTH RIDGEVILLE — Heritage Christian outscored the Royals in each quarter en route to victory.

Ravi Dipali paced Lake Ridge with 10 points, including two 3-point baskets.

The Royals, 0-3, host Christian Community on Friday.

Heritage									
Player	G	F	T	Lake Ridge	G	F	T		
Lange	5	0	13	Dipali	4	0	9		
Dahlke	1	0	2	Whiteman	4	0	9		
Pultz	7	3	19	Flannery	1	2	4		
Farley	2	0	4	Kaltenstein	2	1	5		
Wacker	3	4	6	Guthrie	1	1	3		
Starr	5	0	10	Maccuzak	4	0	8		
Piazza	2	1	6	Moore	1	0	3		
Hornsham	2	2	6	McCligh	1	0	2		
Totals	37	7	71	Totals	23	8	55		

Points by Quarters 1 2 3 4 T
Heritage 16 20 13 16 — 65
Lake Ridge 10 11 17 15 — 55

Three-point goals: Heritage Christian — Pultz; Lake Ridge — Dipali, 2, Whiteman, Moore.

Junior Varsity: Lake Ridge, 42-33.

Richmond Heights.....72
First Baptist.....51

RICHMOND HEIGHTS — J.R. Atkinson's game-high 27 points led Richmond Heights in non-conference action.

Tim Stedman (19), Luke Warner (16) and Louie Wacker (10) scored in double figures for the Sabres.

The Sabres, 1-1, journey to Dalton next Tuesday.

FBCS									
Player	G	F	T	Rich. Hts.	G	F	T		
Stedman	7	2	19	Atkinson	11	0	27		
Warner	7	0	16	Roach	2	1	5		
Grawold	2	0	4	Starr	5	2	13		
Wacker	3	4	10	Ali	3	0	2		
Rogers	1	0	2	Pryor	3	0	2		
				Warth	7	1	15		
Totals	20	6	51	Totals	29	4	72		

Points by Quarters 1 2 3 4 T
FBCS 17 9 8 17 — 51
Rich. Hts. 25 10 17 20 — 72

Three-point goals: First Baptist — Stedman 3, Warner 2, Richmond Heights — Atkinson, Starr.

Junior Varsity: Richmond Heights, 64-29.

Canton McKinley.....74
Olmsted Falls.....64

CANTON — Canton McKinley (2-0) spoiled Olmsted Falls' season opener.

The game was a makeup from Saturday night when Canton

McKinley's football team won its second straight Division I state championship.

Mike Gansey led Olmsted Falls with 17 points. Larry Mucha and Sean Radigan each added 15.

The Bulldogs journey to Westlake on Friday for their first SWC game.

Olm. Falls									
Player	G	F	T	McKinley	G	F	T		
Mucha	6	2	15	Campbell	3	4	11		
M. Williams	3	1	7	Broyles	6	2	15		
E. Williams	0	1	1	Waltz	1	0	2		
Gansey	8	1	17	Betts	1	3	5		
Radigan	7	0	15	Betta	4	3	12		
Schneider	2	0	4	Tibovich	4	4	18		
Koch	2	0	5	Owens	1	0	2		
Totals	28	5	64	Totals	24	19	74		

Points by Quarters 1 2 3 4 T
Olm. Falls 13 16 18 — 64
McKinley 15 17 18 22 — 74

Three-point goals: Olmsted Falls — Mucha, Radigan, Koch; McKinley — Campbell, Broyles, Betts, Tibovich.

Mogadore.....73
Open Door.....54

MOGADORE — Mogadore grabbed a 17-point lead after the first quarter and never looked back.

Josh Smith and Brian Mczey combined for 33 points for the Patriots. Smith and Mczey each had three 3-pointers.

Open Door									
Player	G	F	T	Mogadore	G	F	T		
Wilken	1	0	2	Nelson	3	1	8		
Mezey	5	0	13	Shuff	2	1	6		
Smith	7	3	20	Cumby	6	2	13		
Pycraft	3	0	8	Custer	2	0	4		
Ripple	0	1	1	Lane	8	1	17		
Taylor	2	1	8	Francis	5	0	10		
Moore	1	1	1	McClary	1	0	2		
Green	0	3	3	McClary	6	0	13		
Totals	19	5	54	Totals	33	4	73		

Points by Quarters 1 2 3 4 T
Open Door 6 10 13 16 — 54
Mogadore 23 19 12 — 73

Three-point goals: Open Door — Mezey 3, Smith 5, Ripley, Mack; Mogadore — Nelson, Shuff, McClary.

Junior Varsity: Mogadore, 53-41.

Brunswick.....72
Avon Lake.....50

BRUNSWICK — Brunswick outscored the Shoremen in each quarter of its non-conference game.

Dan May led Avon Lake's scorebook with his game-high 27 points.

Avon Lake (66): Ang 8, Hight 3, Quarters 4, 10 Hampton 6, Jones 2, May 27, Hamei 2, Skellenger 4.									
BRUNSWICK (72): Mixon 21, Moore 4, Herman 10 arenoski 8, Relic 8, Sergott 5, Frierson 1, Winielwa Heazer 4, Reminder 11.									
Points by Quarters									
	1	2	3	4	T				
on Lake	8	13	14	15	50				
Brunswick	18	10	14	10	52				